TEACHER GUIDE

S3 CH05 — The Potter's Valley

Lesson Overview

Chapter: S3 CH05 — The Potter's Valley
Season: 3 — Makers and Creators
Episode runtime: ~8 minutes per level

LEAPS Framework

- **L — Launch:** Vocabulary activation before the episode
- **E — Explore:** Episode viewing with guided prompts
- **A — Apply:** Reading passage + comprehension exercises
- **P — Practice:** Written response + formative check
- **S — Share:** Discussion protocol + portfolio page

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Identify and use 5 vocabulary words (kiln, vessel, symmetry, patient, craft) in context
- Retell key events from the episode in sequence
- Read an original informational passage and locate text evidence
- Produce a written response connecting patience to craft
- Participate in structured academic discussion using accountable talk stems

Lesson Timeline

Phase	Level A	Level B	Level C	Level D	Activity
Launch	7 min	6 min	5 min	5 min	Vocabulary introduction with gestures
Explore	10 min	10 min	10 min	10 min	Episode viewing with 3 pause discussions
Apply	10 min	15 min	18 min	20 min	Reading passage + comprehension questions
Practice	5 min	7 min	10 min	12 min	Written response to prompt
Share	3 min	3 min	4 min	5 min	Discussion protocol + portfolio
Total	**35 min**	**41 min**	**47 min**	**52 min**	

Preparation Checklist

- ☐ Read this guide fully the night before
- ☐ Queue episode to beginning (or locate Read-Aloud Backup on last page if technology unavailable)

Launch Phase Facilitation

Duration: 5-7 min (all levels)

What the Teacher Does

Step-by-step facilitation:

1. Display all 5 vocabulary word cards where students can see them
2. Introduce each word using the sequence below
3. Model the gesture for each word and have students practice
4. For Level A: oral only, no writing; students point and gesture
5. For Level D: students predict definition from morphology first

Key Questions to Pose

- "Have you ever seen someone making pottery? What did they do?"
- "What do you think happens to clay when it gets really hot?"
- "Why might making pottery need patience?"
- "What does it mean when both sides of something match perfectly?"

Vocabulary Introduction Sequence

For each word:

1. Show word card, say the word together (choral response)
2. Students perform gesture (gestures listed below)
3. Teacher gives kid-friendly definition
4. Students write "before" definition in their pack (Levels B, C, D only)
5. Quick pair-share: "Where might you see a [word]?"

Vocabulary Words and Gestures

kiln: mime opening oven door with both hands

vessel: cup hands together as if holding a bowl

symmetry: hold both hands up, mirror them left-right

patient: slow deep breath, hands folded

craft: mime shaping clay with both hands

Monitoring Flags

- If fewer than half the class can gesture all 5 words after introduction → spend 2 extra minutes on vocabulary before moving to episode

Explore Phase Facilitation

Duration: 10 min (episode) + pause discussions

What the Teacher Does

- Project episode on shared screen (We Screen model — students do not need individual devices)
- Pause at Scene 5 (~2:00), Scene 12 (~4:48), Scene 18 (~7:12)
- At each pause: pose question, cold-call 2-3 students, max 60 seconds of discussion, continue

Pause Point Facilitation

PAUSE 1 — Scene 5 | Timestamp ~2:00

Episode context: The Potter explains that clay is soft and requires gentle hands and patience; rushing makes everything collapse

Question: "Why do you think the Potter says clay needs patience?"

What to listen for: Student responses should mention that clay is soft/fragile, rushing makes it collapse, or that careful work takes time

If discussion is flat: "What happened to the pots on the shelf that were rushed?"

Level differentiation:

- **Level A:** "What does Celeste say about being gentle with clay?"
- **Level D:** "How is working with clay different from working with wood, and what does that teach us about different skills?"

PAUSE 2 — Scene 12 | Timestamp ~4:48

Episode context: The Potter demonstrates centering clay on the wheel; she explains that centering yourself helps the clay follow

Question: "What does Celeste mean when she says 'center yourself first, and the clay will follow'?"

What to listen for: Responses about staying calm, not being tense, the clay feeling your emotions, or that being centered/balanced helps

If discussion is flat: "What happened when Layla was tense and the clay felt her tension?"

Level differentiation:

- **Level A:** "What is Celeste doing to the clay on the wheel?"
- **Level D:** "Why might your own calmness affect how the clay behaves? What's the connection?"

Apply Phase Facilitation

Duration: 15-20 min (varies by level)

What the Teacher Does

- Distribute/direct students to reading passage pages
- **Level A:** Teacher reads aloud while students follow along
- **Level B:** Partner reading, then independent questions
- **Level C-D:** Independent reading, then questions

Reading Support Moves

- **Before reading:** "As you read, underline any sentence that tells you something new about pottery"
- **During reading:** Circulate, note students who finish quickly (potential Level D reassignment signal) and students who re-read the same lines repeatedly (potential Level B reassignment signal)
- **After reading:** "Turn to page [X]. Let's look at question 3 together before you answer independently."

Comprehension Question Guidance

Level A

Assessment: Story sequence (cut and paste images in order) + word-picture matching

What it assesses: Understanding of episode sequence, vocabulary recognition

Common error: Mixing up "Next" and "Then" order

Proficient response: All 4 images in correct First → Next → Then → Last order

Level B

Assessment: 2 picture-supported MC + 1 sentence frame short answer

Common error: Not using the passage to find answers, relying only on episode

Proficient response: Answers cite passage evidence, frame completed fully

Level C

Assessment: 2 MC + 2 short answer

Q3: "Find a sentence in the passage that shows pottery requires patience. Write it here."

Practice Phase Facilitation

Duration: 10-12 min

What the Teacher Does

- Direct students to written response page
- Read the prompt aloud for all levels
- **Level A:** Oral response to teacher, teacher scribes
- **Level B:** Complete sentence frames independently
- **Level C:** Write paragraph with sentence starter
- **Level D:** Write analytical paragraph, no starter

Written Response Prompts by Level

Level	Format	Prompt/Frame
Level A	Drawing + dictation	Frame: "Celeste showed us that ____" Teacher writes what student dictates
Level B	Sentence frames (5 lines)	"Celeste taught the kids that ____. This matters because ____."
Level C	Paragraph with starter (8 lines)	Starter: "Patience is important in pottery because ____" Reminder: "claim → evidence → explanation"
Level D	Analytical paragraph, no starter (10 lines)	"Explain how patience functions as a skill. Use evidence from both the episode and the reading passage." Structure labeled: claim / evidence / evidence / closing

Key Facilitation Moves

- "Before you write, think for 30 seconds. What's your claim?" (C and D only)
- "If you're stuck, look back at your listening guide from the episode and your reading passage. Evidence lives there."
- For students who finish early: direct to Extension page (Level C) or second paragraph (Level D)

Formative Check — What to Observe

Behavior	Not Yet	Approaching	Got It
Uses vocabulary from lesson in writing	No vocab words used	1 vocab word attempted	2+ vocab words used correctly
Provides specific evidence	Says "because I said so" or generic	Mentions episode/passage vaguely	Cites specific detail or quote

Share Phase Facilitation

Duration: 4-5 min

What the Teacher Does

- **Level A:** Whole-class partner share, teacher facilitates
- **Level B:** Structured pair share with sentence frames
- **Level C:** Small-group accountable talk (groups of 3-4), one reporter shares with class
- **Level D:** Student-generated questions, partner exchange

Accountable Talk Setup (Level C)

- Assign groups of 3-4 before lesson starts
- Post stems on board in addition to student packs:
  - "I noticed that ___"
  - "I agree with ___ because ___"
  - "I have a different idea: ___"
- Give groups 3 minutes, then cold-call one reporter per group
- Reporter shares: "Our group's most important idea was ___"
- Do not let any one group dominate. Move quickly.

Portfolio Page

- Students complete self-rating (1-4) independently
- "What do I want to get better at?" — accept any honest response
- This is not assessed, it's metacognitive
- Collect all portfolio pages for the season journal OR direct students to their own folders

Designated ELD Extension (2-3 minutes, if time)

Emerging (Beginning): "Point to the picture that shows a kiln."

Expanding (Intermediate): "Use the word 'vessel' in a sentence about pottery."

Bridging (Advanced): "Explain what symmetry means using your own words and a real-life example."

Differentiation + Misconceptions

Differentiation Strategies

For Advanced Learners

- Extension page: compare Celeste's teaching to a teacher in their school
- Research: find one real pottery tradition connected to their own cultural background
- Challenge question: "Is pottery a craft, an art, or both? What's the difference?"

For Approaching-Level Learners

- Vocabulary page: provide definitions pre-filled, student copies and illustrates
- Reading passage: read aloud together before independent questions
- Written response: extend the sentence frame from Level B packet if Level C frame isn't enough scaffold
- One-on-one check-in during Apply phase

For English Learners

- Pre-teach vocabulary using gestures and images before the lesson (5 min before class if possible)
- Flag cognates explicitly during Launch (vasija, simetría, paciente, artesanía)
- Allow Spanish response on Portfolio page
- Pair with a supportive peer for Discussion Protocol
- Accept oral response in lieu of written response for formative check

Common Misconceptions to Address

Misconception	Redirect
"Patience just means waiting"	"Patience means continuing to try carefully even when it's hard. What did Celeste do when the kids' clay collapsed?"
"Craft is just for art class"	"What crafts do people do as jobs? What do you think makes someone a master of a craft?"

Assessment + Standards + Connections

Assessment Summary

Formative (during lesson):

- Vocabulary gesture check during Launch
- Listening Guide completeness after Explore
- Comprehension question accuracy (Apply)
- Written response paragraph (Practice)
- Observation during Discussion Protocol (Share)

Summative contribution:

- Portfolio page accumulates into Season 3 Learning Journal
- Written response is a gradeable artifact
- Use rubric below for written response scoring

Written Response Rubric (4-point, Level C)

Score	Description
4 — Exceeds	Clear claim using vocabulary word(s), 2+ specific examples from episode or passage, concluding thought
3 — Meets	Clear claim, 1 specific example, attempts conclusion
2 — Approaching	Claim present but vague, example is a retelling not evidence
1 — Beginning	Response does not address prompt or is incomplete

Standards Alignment (Level C / Grade 3)

CA CCSS for ELA/Literacy:

- Reading Literature: RL.3.1, RL.3.4
- Reading Informational: RI.3.1, RI.3.4
- Writing: W.3.1, W.3.2
- Speaking & Listening: SL.3.1, SL.3.4, SL.3.6
- Language: L.3.4, L.3.4b, L.3.6
- Foundational Skills: RF.3.3

CA ELD Standards (Grade 3):

- Part I: A1 (collaborative), A5 (listening actively), B6 (reading closely)
- Part II: B4 (using verbs/verb phrases), C11 (nominalization)

Texas ELPS (2026-2027 5-Level System): Vocabulary/Launch: Levels 3-4 | Comprehension: Levels 3-4 | Writing: Levels 3-4

FL B.E.S.T.: ELA.3.R.1.1, ELA.3.R.2.1, ELA.3.C.1.2, ELA.3.F.1.3

> **CA Program Type 3 Biliteracy note:** Spanish passage = original composition, not translation. Spanish linguistic modifications documented in Spanish Teacher Guide edition. Citation standard: CA CCSS for ELA/Literacy per EC Section 60005(b)

Connections

Prior chapters: This chapter introduces core craft vocabulary that will spiral through Ch6-8. The concepts of patience and practice build on the foundation established in Ch1-4.

Next chapter: S3 Ch06 — Throwing and Turning builds on patience and craft vocabulary established here. New vocabulary will include additional pottery techniques and tools.

Season arc: This is the pivot chapter of Act 2. Students should understand by end of lesson that mastery takes repeated practice — this theme accelerates in Ch06-08.

> ### Quick Note for Substitutes
>
> You do not need to know anything about pottery to teach this lesson. Your job is to follow the LEAPS phases, pose the questions on each page, and circulate during independent work. The students' packs guide them through every activity. If technology fails, use the Read-Aloud Backup on the next page.

[Read-Aloud Backup text would appear on following page]